Jothi Tutor Development Standards

TUTOR COMPETENCY FRAMEWORK

A structured framework for developing, observing, and recognising high-quality academic tutoring within the Jothi Tutor Academy

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Publication date
March 2026

Document ID
JTD01 - 1.0

Purpose of the Document

This document defines the tutor competency framework used within the Jothi Tutor Academy. Its purpose is to identify the core teaching competencies tutors are expected to develop, demonstrate, and strengthen as they progress through the academy.

The framework gives the academy a shared language for tutor development. It helps tutors understand what strong teaching consists of in practice, helps mentors observe and coach in a more consistent way, and supports competency sign-off and certification decisions with clearer evidence.

This document is not intended as a theoretical list detached from real teaching. It is a practical developmental framework rooted in the academy's lesson model, teaching standards, and mentor observation process.

Intended Audience

This document is intended for:

- tutors progressing through the Jothi Tutor Academy
- mentors responsible for coaching, observation, and developmental judgement
- academy leadership overseeing tutor training, readiness, and certification

Related JTA Documents

- JF03 — The 4T Teaching Engine
- JTS01 — Lesson Delivery Standard
- JTD02 — Tutor Lesson Reflection Standard
- JTD03 — Tutor Residency Progress Framework
- JTD04 — Mentor Observation Standard
- JTD06 — Tutor Certification and Sign-Off Standard

1. Purpose of the Competency Framework

The Jothi Tutor Academy is designed to develop tutors through a structured process rather than through informal experience alone. For that process to work well, the academy needs a clear definition of what tutors are actually expected to become competent in.

The competency framework provides that definition.

It identifies the teaching skills, professional behaviours, and developmental expectations that tutors should demonstrate over time. In doing so, it prevents tutor development from becoming vague or overly impressionistic. It also makes mentor feedback more consistent, because tutors can be coached against shared instructional expectations rather than personal preference alone.

2. Relationship to the Jothi Teaching Model

The competency framework is closely linked to the wider JTA system.

- The **Jothi Trifecta** provides the philosophical foundation for teaching and learning.
- The **4T Teaching Engine** provides the instructional model used in lessons.
- The **JTS series** defines the operational teaching standards tutors are expected to follow.
- The **JTD series** defines how tutors are developed, observed, and certified.

Within this wider structure, the competency framework defines what a tutor must be able to do in order to teach effectively and consistently within the Jothi model.

The competencies are therefore not separate from the teaching system. They are the developmental expression of it.

3. Principles of the Competency Framework

The framework is guided by the following principles:

- competencies should be observable in live teaching

- development should be progressive, not assumed
- strong teaching includes both instructional skill and professional conduct
- mentor judgement should be informed by shared criteria
- competency recognition should be based on evidence, not impression alone

The purpose of the framework is not to reduce teaching to a checklist. Its purpose is to make developmental expectations clearer and more reliable.

4. Structure of the Framework

The competency framework is organised into three levels:

- **JCT1 — Core Teaching Competencies**
- **JCT2 — Developing Teaching Competencies**
- **JCT3 — Advanced Teaching Competencies**

These levels reflect increasing maturity and consistency in teaching practice. They should not be treated as rigid status labels. Their purpose is to describe a developmental pathway through which tutors move from foundational teaching behaviours toward stronger instructional judgement and wider professional contribution.

A tutor is not expected to demonstrate every competency at once. Competencies are built progressively through observation, practice, mentor feedback, reflection, and repeated live teaching.

5. JCT1 — Core Teaching Competencies

Core competencies represent the foundational teaching skills expected of tutors in the earlier stages of development. These are the competencies that allow a tutor to deliver a lesson clearly, interact meaningfully with the student, and begin working within the Jothi teaching model.

C1. Explaining concepts clearly

The tutor can explain a concept in a way that is understandable, logically sequenced, and appropriately paced.

C2. Asking diagnostic questions

The tutor can ask questions that reveal whether the student has genuinely understood the explanation.

C3. Monitoring student thinking

The tutor notices how the student is reasoning, including hesitation, confusion, and error patterns.

C4. Correcting misconceptions

The tutor can respond to misunderstanding by identifying the error and guiding the student toward stronger understanding.

C5. Structuring lessons clearly

The tutor can maintain a coherent lesson flow rather than teaching in a fragmented or improvised way.

C6. Using the digital board effectively

The tutor can use the board or writing surface clearly enough to make reasoning visible and understandable.

C7. Encouraging student reasoning

The tutor prompts the student to explain their thinking rather than relying only on short answers or passive listening.

C8. Maintaining student engagement

The tutor keeps the student mentally involved in the lesson through explanation, questioning, and participation.

C9. Communicating clearly with students

The tutor speaks clearly, gives understandable instructions, and maintains a productive learning tone.

C10. Maintaining professional teaching conduct

The tutor demonstrates readiness, composure, punctuality, and professional behaviour appropriate to the academy.

6. JCT2 — Developing Teaching Competencies

Developing competencies reflect a stronger level of instructional control and adaptability. At this level, the tutor is not only delivering lessons more clearly, but also responding more intelligently to student need.

D1. Diagnosing student misconceptions with accuracy

The tutor can identify the likely source of misunderstanding rather than only noticing that an answer is wrong.

D2. Adapting explanation to student need

The tutor can modify explanation, example choice, or pace in response to the student's level and difficulty.

D3. Guiding students through complex problems

The tutor can support the student through more demanding problems without taking over the thinking too quickly.

D4. Promoting independent problem solving

The tutor can gradually reduce support so that the student begins to think and work more independently.

D5. Using examples strategically

The tutor chooses or sequences examples in a way that improves conceptual understanding and exposes key differences.

D6. Managing lesson pacing effectively

The tutor balances explanation, questioning, and student work so the lesson remains purposeful without becoming rushed.

D7. Encouraging student reflection

The tutor helps the student think about errors, methods, and improvement rather than only receiving correction passively.

D8. Connecting concepts across topics

The tutor helps the student see how ideas relate, rather than treating each topic as isolated.

D9. Supporting examination preparation

The tutor can help the student apply understanding in a more disciplined exam-oriented format where relevant.

D10. Monitoring student progress systematically

The tutor uses assessment and recurring evidence to build an accurate picture of development over time.

7. JCT3 — Advanced Teaching Competencies

Advanced competencies reflect a higher level of teaching maturity, consistency, and contribution to the academy. At this level, the tutor is expected not only to teach well, but to sustain strong teaching across complexity and contribute more broadly to quality.

A1. Designing structured lesson sequences

The tutor can plan and deliver learning in a way that shows clear sequencing across lessons, not only within one lesson.

A2. Anticipating common misconceptions

The tutor can predict likely misconceptions in advance and teach with those risks in mind.

A3. Coaching students in advanced reasoning

The tutor can support students in more demanding analytical thinking while preserving clarity and structure.

A4. Supporting long-term student progress

The tutor can help sustain academic development over time rather than focusing only on short-term task completion.

A5. Integrating assessment into teaching

The tutor uses assessment naturally and intelligently as part of ongoing instruction, not only as a separate event.

A6. Sustaining high instructional clarity across complex teaching

The tutor maintains clarity even when dealing with difficult content, layered reasoning, or higher student challenge.

A7. Modelling effective problem-solving strategies

The tutor can demonstrate disciplined and transferable ways of approaching unfamiliar or demanding questions.

A8. Mentoring junior tutors

Where relevant, the tutor can support the development of less experienced tutors in line with academy expectations.

A9. Maintaining high professional teaching standards

The tutor demonstrates dependable professionalism and instructional maturity across sustained practice.

A10. Contributing to teaching improvement within the academy

The tutor contributes positively to the academy's instructional culture, consistency, or developmental processes.

8. How Competencies Should Be Interpreted

Competencies should be interpreted as live teaching capabilities, not abstract labels. They should be judged by repeated observable evidence across real lessons.

This means that competencies should not normally be signed off on the basis of:

- one isolated strong moment
- tutor self-report alone
- general positive impression without lesson evidence

Instead, competencies should be judged through patterns of demonstrated teaching behaviour over time.

9. Relationship to Residency Progress

Competency development takes place across the tutor residency pathway.

- In early residency, tutors begin developing core competencies through observation and supported practice.
- In middle stages, tutors strengthen developing competencies through lead teaching and feedback.
- In later stages, tutors demonstrate increasing consistency, independence, and readiness for certification.

The competency framework and the residency framework are therefore closely connected, but they are not identical. Residency describes the developmental pathway. Competencies describe what the tutor is becoming able to do within that pathway.

10. Relationship to Reflection, Observation, and Certification

The competency framework supports several other parts of the JTA system.

Tutor reflection

JTD02 helps tutors reflect on which teaching skills they are using well and which they need to improve.

Mentor observation

JTD04 allows mentors to observe live evidence of competency development and provide feedback against real teaching behaviour.

Certification

JTD06 uses accumulated competency evidence as part of the decision about whether a tutor is ready for independent teaching.

This framework therefore acts as a bridge between day-to-day teaching and the academy's formal development process.

11. Evidence of Competency Development

Evidence of competency development may come from:

- live teaching observation
- lesson reflection
- repeated demonstration across lessons
- assessment-informed teaching decisions
- visible improvement in clarity, questioning, monitoring, and correction
- mentor judgement supported by concrete examples

Competency recognition should remain evidence-based, developmental, and proportionate.

12. Common Misuse Risks

The competency framework should be used carefully. The following misuses should be avoided:

- treating competencies as a tick-box exercise
- assuming that subject knowledge alone proves teaching competence
- signing off competencies too early without repeated evidence
- using the framework as a vague impression list rather than a developmental tool
- ignoring the difference between residency stage and actual teaching competence

These risks weaken the credibility of the framework and reduce its developmental value.

13. Relationship to the Wider JTA System

This document helps hold the wider JTA system together by defining what good teaching competence looks like in developmental terms.

It is closely connected to:

- JF03, because the 4T model shapes the kind of competencies tutors must develop
- JTS01, because lesson delivery is one of the main places competency becomes visible
- JTD03, because residency progression should be informed by competency development
- JTD04, because mentor observation is a major source of competency evidence
- JTD06, because certification depends in part on demonstrated competence

The framework therefore gives the academy a consistent basis for developmental judgement.

14. Conclusion

The Tutor Competency Framework provides the Jothi Tutor Academy with a structured way to define, observe, and develop high-quality academic tutoring. It ensures that tutor development is based on real teaching capability rather than assumption, confidence, or subject knowledge alone.

Its purpose is not to reduce teaching to a checklist, but to make professional growth clearer, more evidence-based, and more consistent across the academy.